

Talking About AI

You can weigh a claim for yourself now. But you'll also be the person friends, family, and teachers ask about AI, often with a worry sitting under the question. The move is to meet the worry, not the soundbite.

TALKING ABOUT AI

When people ask, here's what they're really worried about.

The questions you'll get usually have a real concern underneath. Address that, not the soundbite.

"AI is going to take over."

They're worried about agents doing stuff without supervision. That's a real risk worth taking seriously. The fix is the Five-Word Rule: AI shouldn't send, spend, submit, delete, or post without you reviewing first.

"AI is going to take all the jobs."

They're probably worried about work changing faster than people can adapt. That's a fair concern. The better frame is task-by-task: which tasks get automated, which need a human in the loop, and which new skills become valuable as the mix shifts.

"AI is just hype, it'll pass."

They may be reacting against exaggerated claims, which is understandable: there's a lot of overclaiming on the optimist side. But hype cycles end while the technology doesn't. The internet was overhyped in 1999, and it's still here.

"Kids these days just use AI to cheat."

They're worried about whether you're actually learning. Same tool, different outcomes depending on how you use it. Use AI to learn faster, not to skip the learning.

The smartest people aren't the ones who panic or worship.

They're the ones who can judge.

You can talk about AI clearly.

Meet the worry with what you know.